EXPERIMENT 13

CASE STUDY ON LOW-CODE LIMITATIONS

AIM

To examine the benefits and limitations of low-code development through a case study of a Library Book Issue Management application in Zoho Creator.

DESCRIPTION

Case study overview

A library wants to manage book requests, issue dates, due dates, returns, overdue reminders, and fines. Zoho Creator can be used to build forms, reports, workflows, and dashboards with limited traditional coding.

Benefits of low-code

Visual form and report builders help create an initial application quickly. Workflow rules can automate notifications and routine tasks. Deluge scripts allow custom logic, and integrations can connect the application with other services. Changes can often be made faster than building every component from scratch.

Customization limits

A low-code platform still has boundaries. Highly specialized user interfaces, unusual algorithms, complex background processing, or advanced device-level features may require custom code or another service. Developers must check which capabilities are supported by the platform and plan before promising a feature.

Performance and scale

Large datasets, inefficient queries, frequent workflows, and multiple API calls can affect responsiveness. The application should be tested with realistic volumes. Platform limits, API quotas, and plan-specific restrictions may influence design and operating cost.

Vendor and portability considerations

Applications may depend on Zoho Creator, Deluge, and platform-specific features. Moving to another platform may require rewriting workflows and integrations. Export and migration options should be reviewed before choosing a long-term architecture.

Security and governance considerations

Low-code development does not remove the need for access control, secure credential handling, validation, backups, and compliance. Visual configuration can still introduce security mistakes if permissions and data sharing are not reviewed.

Recommendations

Use low-code for forms, workflow automation, and standard business applications where the platform fits. Prototype risky requirements early, measure performance, document dependencies, and use APIs or pro-code services when a requirement exceeds built-in capabilities.

RESULT

The case study showed that Zoho Creator can efficiently support common library workflows, while complex customization, scaling, portability, and platform limits must be evaluated during application design.